

Project Plan

- **Total number of days:** 97 days.

1. Initiation Phase: 2 Weeks (14 Days)

1. Interview Meeting with Al Salam Bank Team

- Objective: Gather detailed requirements and expectations from the client.
 - A list of questions to ask: **(Amina) we go there specify a time.**
 - What are the key features they expect in the platform? **(Urgent-mid-not)**
We continue or others.
 - What are their expectations regarding student involvement and deliverables?
 - How many responses they want for the survey? (120)

2. Project Charter

- Objective: Define the project's purpose, objectives, and high-level scope.
 - Draft the Project Charter with input from key stakeholders (Al Salam Bank and Bahrain Polytechnic University).
 - Business Plan: Objectives, benefits, and success criteria.
 - Stakeholders: Roles and responsibilities (use a RACI matrix if needed).
 - High-Level Scope: In-scope and out-of-scope items.
 - Budget and Timeline: Estimated budget and project duration.

3. Define the Project Scope (In-Scope / Out-of-Scope)

- Objective: Clearly define what is included and excluded from the project.
 - Based on the client's input, create a Scope Statement that includes:
 - Requirements: Functional and non-functional requirements.
 - Features: Key features of the platform (user registration, project posting, collaboration tools).
 - Functions: Specific functionalities (progress tracking, revision workflows).
 - Infrastructure – Technology their IT teams use.
 - Clearly outline out-of-scope items (mobile app development, advanced AI features)

4. Business Requirement Document (BRD): Signature

- Objective: Finalize and formalize the project requirements.
 - Develop a Business Requirement Document (BRD) that includes:
 - Detailed descriptions of all platform features and functionalities.
 - Acceptance criteria for each feature.
 - Constraints (budget, timeline, resources).
 - Present the BRD to Al Salam Bank and Bahrain Polytechnic University for review.
 - Obtain formal signatures from stakeholders to confirm agreement on the requirements.

5. Design Planning (3 weeks)

- Objective: Plan the design and development of the platform.
 - Define Components: Identify the main components of the platform (frontend, backend, database).
 - Time and Dependency: Create a high-level timeline for each component, considering dependencies between tasks.
 - Distribution of Requirements: Assign responsibilities for each requirement to the relevant team members.
 - Functions: Define the specific functions of each component and how they will be developed.

6. Full Project Plan

- Objective: Develop a comprehensive project plan to guide execution.
 - Create a Project Plan that includes:
 - Timeline: Detailed schedule with milestones and deadlines.
 - Resource Allocation: Assign tasks to team members and define their roles.
 - Risk Management Plan: Identify potential risks and mitigation strategies.
 - Communication Plan: Define how and when stakeholders will be updated on progress.

7. Execution Preparation

- Objective: Prepare for the execution phase of the project.
 - Team Briefing: Conduct a meeting with the project team to review the Project Plan and assign tasks.
 - Tool Setup: Set up necessary tools and software for development.
 - Kickoff Meeting: Hold a formal kickoff meeting with all stakeholders to officially start the project.

2. Planning: 3 weeks (21 days)

- Develop a detailed project plan, including timelines and milestones.
- Conduct requirement analysis with stakeholders.
- Define platform features and functionalities.
- Allocate resources (team members, budget, tools).
- Finalize the project schedule and risk management plan.

3. Execution: 8 weeks (56 days)

- Develop the platform prototype (frontend and backend).
- Implement core features (user registration, project posting, collaboration tools).
- Conduct internal testing and debugging.
- Prepare training materials for students and bank staff.
- Begin pilot testing with a small group of users.

4. Monitoring and Controlling: 2 weeks (14 days)

- Monitor progress against the project plan.
- Address any issues or risks that arise during execution.
- Collect feedback from pilot testing and make necessary adjustments.
- Ensure the platform meets all functional and technical requirements.

5. Closure: 2 weeks (14 days)

- Finalize platform development and conduct user acceptance testing (UAT).
- Train students and bank staff on how to use the platform.
- Launch the platform and onboard users.
- Conduct a post-project review to evaluate success and document lessons learned.

Functional Requirements Details

1. User Registration and Authentication (Individual – Common) Our names

1. Users (students and bank representatives) click on **“Sign Up”** and choose their role (student, client, or admin).
 2. They fill in basic details (name, email, password) and verify their email through a confirmation link.
 3. After verification, users can log in using their credentials.
 4. **Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)** can be enabled for added security, requiring a code sent to their phone or email.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use **OAuth 2.0** or **JWT (JSON Web Tokens)** for secure authentication.
 2. Store user credentials securely using **hashing algorithms** (e.g., bcrypt).
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2. Profile Management

1. After registration, users are prompted to complete their profiles.
 2. **Students** can upload portfolios, list skills, and add experience.
 3. **Clients** (bank representatives) can add their job roles and contact information.
 4. Profiles are editable, and users can update their information at any time.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use a **relational database** (e.g., MySQL) to store profile data.
 2. Allow file uploads (e.g., PDFs, images) for portfolios, with a size limit of **50MB**.
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3. Project Posting

1. Clients log in and click on **“Post a Project.”**
 2. They fill out a form with project details:
 - Title, description, and objectives.
 - Required skills (e.g., graphic design, content writing).
 - Deadlines and deliverables.
 3. The project is posted and visible to students in the **freelancer marketplace**.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use a **form builder** with validation to ensure all required fields are filled.
 2. Store project details in a database and display them in a searchable list.
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4. Task Assignment

1. Students browse available projects and click **“Apply”** on tasks that match their skills.
 2. Clients review applications and assign tasks to the most suitable students.
 3. Automated notifications inform students when they are assigned a task.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use a **matching algorithm** to suggest relevant tasks to students based on their skills.
 2. Send notifications via **email** or **in-platform alerts**.
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5. Collaboration Tools

1. Students and clients can communicate through an **in-platform messaging system**.
 2. Users can upload and share files (e.g., project briefs, drafts) with a size limit of **50MB**.
 3. Integrated **video call functionality** allows for virtual meetings.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use **WebSockets** or **Socket.io** for real-time messaging.
 2. Integrate third-party APIs (e.g., Zoom, Google Meet) for video calls.
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6. Progress Tracking

1. A **dashboard** displays real-time updates on project status, including:
 - Task completion percentages.
 - Upcoming deadlines.
 - Freelancer performance metrics.
 2. Clients and students can track progress at a glance.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use **data visualization libraries** (e.g., Chart.js, D3.js) to create charts and graphs.
 2. Store progress data in a database and update it in real-time.

7. Revision and Approval Workflow

1. Students submit deliverables through the platform.
 2. Clients review the work and can either:
 - Approve the deliverable.
 - Request revisions with specific feedback.
 3. Students receive notifications about revision requests and can resubmit updated deliverables.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use a **version control system** to track changes to deliverables.
 2. Send automated notifications via email or in-platform alert

8. Freelancer Marketplace

1. Clients browse a **directory** of students (freelancers) with profiles, skills, and ratings.
 2. Filters allow clients to search by skills, experience, ratings, and availability.
 3. Clients can view student portfolios and reviews before assigning tasks.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use a **search engine** (e.g., Elasticsearch) for fast and accurate filtering.
 2. Store freelancer data in a database and display it in a user-friendly interface.

9. Project Management Tools

- **Workflow:**
 1. Break down projects into smaller tasks with deadlines and assignees.
 2. Set and track key milestones for each project.
 3. Automated reminders notify users of upcoming deadlines.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use a **task management system** (e.g., Kanban boards) to organize tasks.
 2. Send automated reminders via email or in-platform alerts.

10. Notifications

1. Automated notifications are sent for:
 - Task assignments.
 - Project updates.
 - Upcoming deadlines.
 - Revision requests and approvals.
 2. Notifications are delivered via email and in-platform alerts.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use a **notification service** (e.g., Firebase Cloud Messaging) to send alerts.
 2. Store notification preferences in a database for customization.

11. Analytics and Reporting

1. Track campaign performance metrics (e.g., reach, engagement, ROI).
 2. Monitor student performance (e.g., task completion rates, client feedback).
 3. Generate visual reports (e.g., charts, graphs) for easy interpretation of data.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use **data analytics tools** (e.g., Google Analytics, Mixpanel) to track metrics.
 2. Store analytics data in a database and display it in a dashboard.

12. Search and Filter

1. Clients search for freelancers or projects using keywords (e.g., “graphic design,” “social media”).
 2. Filters allow sorting by skills, experience level, ratings, and availability.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use a **search engine** (e.g., Elasticsearch) for fast and accurate filtering.
 2. Store search and filter preferences in a database for customization.
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13. Payment Integration (if applicable)

1. Clients make payments directly through the platform using a secure payment gateway (e.g., PayPal, Stripe).
 2. Students receive payments upon task completion, minus any platform fees.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Integrate a **payment gateway API** for secure transactions.
 2. Store payment data securely and comply with **PCI DSS standards**.
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14. Training Resources

1. Students access a **resource library** with tutorials, guides, and webinars.
 2. They complete training modules and earn certificates for skill development.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use a **learning management system (LMS)** to organize training materials.
 2. Store certificates and progress data in a database.

15. Admin Dashboard

1. Admins log in to a centralized dashboard to manage users, projects, and platform settings.
 2. They can resolve disputes, manage payments, and generate reports.
- **Technical Implementation:**
 1. Use a **role-based access control (RBAC)** system to restrict access to admin features.
 2. Store admin data securely and provide tools for managing the platform.

Features: Detailed Explanations

1. File Upload Functionality

- Users (students and clients) can upload files (e.g., project briefs, deliverables) directly to the platform.
- Supported file types: PDF, DOCX, JPEG, PNG, MP4, etc.
- File size limit: 50MB per file.
- Files are stored temporarily during project execution and deleted after project completion (unless specified otherwise).
- Files are encrypted for security during upload and storage.

2. Analytics for Students (Not Projects)

- **Task Completion Rate:** Percentage of tasks completed on time.
- **Client Feedback:** Ratings and comments from clients.
- **Skill Development:** Progress in specific skills (e.g., graphic design, content writing).
- **Engagement Metrics:** Number of projects applied for and completed.
- **Performance Trends:** Visual graphs showing improvement over time.

3. Evaluation of Freelancers at the Start

- Students complete a **skills assessment** during registration (e.g., quizzes, portfolio submission).
- The platform assigns a **skill level** (e.g., Beginner, Intermediate, Advanced) based on the assessment.
- Clients can filter freelancers by skill level when posting projects.

4. Rating System for Students for Each Application

- After completing a task, clients rate students on a **5-star scale** based on:
 - Quality of work ---- Communication ---- Timeliness.
- Students can view their average rating and individual feedback on their profile.
- Ratings are displayed publicly to help clients make informed decisions.

5. Digital Badges or Points System

- Students earn **points** or **badges** for completing tasks, receiving high ratings, or participating in training.
- Example Badges:
 - **Top Performer:** For consistently high ratings.
 - **Creative Genius:** For exceptional creative work.
 - **Team Player:** For excellent collaboration.
- Points can be redeemed for rewards (e.g., certificates, priority access to high-profile projects).
- Badges are displayed on student profiles to showcase achievements.

Extra

Making VIPs

- **What It Means:**
 - VIPs are **top-performing freelancers** (students) who have demonstrated exceptional skills, reliability, and quality of work.
 - **How It Works:**
 - Students earn VIP status based on metrics like:
 - High ratings from clients.
 - Consistent task completion.
 - Positive feedback and reviews.
 - VIPs receive **special perks**, such as:
 - Higher pay rates (e.g., 20% more than standard rates).
 - Priority access to high-profile projects.
 - Exclusive training opportunities.
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2. Complex Reviewing System

- **What It Means:**
 - A **multi-dimensional review system** that evaluates freelancers based on various criteria, not just cost or speed.
 - **How It Works:**
 - Clients rate freelancers on factors like:
 - Quality of work.
 - Communication skills.
 - Timeliness.
 - Creativity.
 - Reviews are weighted to ensure fairness and accuracy.
 - Freelancers can respond to reviews to provide context or address concerns.
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3. VIPs Get Paid More

- **What It Means:**
 - VIP freelancers earn **higher pay rates** as a reward for their exceptional performance.
 - **How It Works:**
 - The platform sets a **premium rate** for VIPs (e.g., 20% more than standard rates).
 - Clients are informed of the VIP rate upfront and can choose to hire VIPs for high-priority projects.
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4. Selection Not Based on Cost

- **What It Means:**
 - Freelancers are **not selected based on cost**, as pricing is already set by the platform.
 - **How It Works:**
 - Clients choose freelancers based on:
 - Skills and experience.
 - Ratings and reviews.
 - Portfolio quality.
 - This ensures that **quality** is prioritized over cost.
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5. Currency = Grades + Experience

- **What It Means:**
 - The **value** of a freelancer is determined by their **academic grades** and **practical experience**.
 - **How It Works:**
 - Students' profiles display their:
 - Academic performance (e.g., GPA, relevant coursework).
 - Practical experience (e.g., previous projects, internships).
 - This helps clients assess the freelancer's qualifications beyond just ratings.
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6. Model = Client Sets the Price

- **What It Means:**
 - The **pricing model** allows clients to set the budget for each project.
 - **How It Works:**
 - Clients define the budget when posting a project.
 - Freelancers can see the budget before applying, ensuring transparency.
 - The platform may recommend pricing tiers based on project complexity.
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7. How to Bring More Freelancers on the Platform?

- **What It Means:**
 - Strategies to **attract and retain freelancers** (students) on the platform.
- **How It Works:**
 - **Gamification:** Introduce a **points system** where freelancers earn points for completing tasks, receiving high ratings, or participating in training.
 - **Rewards:** Offer incentives like certificates, badges, or priority access to projects.
 - **Marketing:** Promote the platform through university partnerships, social media, and word-of-mouth.

8. Gamification = Point System

- **What It Means:**
 - A **gamified system** that rewards freelancers for their contributions and achievements.
- **How It Works:**
 - Freelancers earn points for:
 - Completing tasks.
 - Receiving high ratings.
 - Participating in training or workshops.
 - Points can be redeemed for rewards like:
 - Certificates.
 - Exclusive project opportunities.
 - Platform perks (e.g., priority support).

9. ID Verification

- **What It Means:**
 - A process to **verify the identity** of freelancers and clients to ensure security and trust.
- **How It Works:**
 - Freelancers and clients upload government-issued IDs (e.g., passport, national ID).
 - The platform verifies the IDs using **third-party verification services**.
 - Verified users receive a badge on their profile, increasing trust and credibility.

10. Web Media = Bringing as Many Users & Understanding What They Need

- **What It Means:**
 - The **web media team** focuses on **user acquisition** and **understanding user needs**.
- **How It Works:**
 - Use **analytics tools** to track user behavior and preferences.
 - Conduct **surveys and feedback sessions** to understand user needs.
 - Create **targeted campaigns** to attract new users to the platform.

11. How Will They Understand What They Need?

- **What It Means:**
 - Strategies to **identify and address user needs**.
 - **How It Works:**
 - **Mini Campaigns:** Run small-scale campaigns to test user preferences and gather feedback.
 - **Competitions:** Host contests or challenges to engage users and gather insights.
 - **Market Data:** Analyze market trends and competitor strategies to identify gaps.
 - **Clear Documentation:** Maintain a detailed plan outlining user needs and how the platform addresses them.
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12. The Startup Team

- The **core team** responsible for launching and managing the platform.
 - **How It Works:**
 - The team includes:
 - Project managers.
 - Developers.
 - Marketing specialists.
 - Client relationship managers.
 - The team works collaboratively to ensure the platform's success.
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13. Think Short Term = Web Media

- **What It Means:**
 - **Short-term goals** focus on **user acquisition** and **platform visibility**.
 - **How It Works:**
 - Use **web media strategies** like social media marketing, SEO, and content marketing to attract users.
 - Focus on **quick wins** to build momentum and credibility.
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14. Think Long Term = Marketing

- **What It Means:**
 - **Long-term goals** focus on **sustained growth** and **brand building**.
- **How It Works:**
 - Develop a **comprehensive marketing strategy** that includes:
 - Brand positioning.
 - Partnerships with universities and businesses.
 - Continuous improvement based on user feedback.

Questions for the Client:

User Roles and Access

Which technologies and software your IT team is using currently?

What roles will exist on the platform?

Should there be separate roles for students, bank employees, and admins?

Platform Features

What features are essential for the platform?

For example, do you need project posting, task assignment, collaboration tools, or progress tracking?

Reporting and Analytics

What kind of reports or analytics do you need?

Should the platform provide insights into campaign performance, freelancer performance, or project success metrics?

Future Scalability

Do you anticipate any future expansions or additional features?

For example, should the platform be designed to support mobile apps or advanced analytics in the future?

How many users do you expect to have initially, and how might that grow over time?

Should the platform be scalable to handle increased user demand?

Miscellaneous

Are there any specific constraints we should be aware of?

For example, budget, timeline, or resource limitations.

What is your definition of success for this project?

For example, is it completing 5 marketing campaigns, reducing costs by 20%, or achieving a specific user satisfaction score?